

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #020 — Phase 2, Film 5: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

THE MOTORTOWN REVUE: DANCING IN THE STREET

THE TEAM-UP • RELEASE: Friday, April 29, 2016

Phase 2, Film 5 • The Avengers: Age of Ultron role • Motown Productions / Paramount •

PG-13 • approx. 180 min (event film)

A. Release Date: Friday, April 29, 2016

Avengers: Age of Ultron opened on Friday, May 1, 2015. Exactly 52 weeks later is **Friday, April 29, 2016**. It opens the summer, one week earlier on the calendar than the May slot, because it keeps the TMU's 52-week rule.

B. The Age of Ultron Blueprint Map

Avengers: Age of Ultron	The Motortown Revue: Dancing in the Street (documented history)
Tony's creation turns on its makers (Ultron)	The Motown machine of control, billing and formula that Gordy built pushes its own stars to breaking point
A city torn apart (Sokovia)	The Detroit riot of July 1967: five days, 43 dead, a mile from Hitsville
The Hulk joins the team at last	David Ruffin's first team-up , with the Temptations at their peak
Newcomers who start as rivals (the Maximoffs)	Gladys Knight & the Pips, outsiders at Motown, whose “Grapevine” reaches #2 before Marvin records it
The team fractures	Florence Ballard is dismissed from the Supremes (1967), HDH stop delivering hits, and Tammi Terrell collapses (Oct. 1967)
The Hulk leaves	Ruffin is fired from the Temptations (June 1968)
A new lineup assembles	Dennis Edwards joins the Temptations, Cindy Birdsong joins the Supremes, and the Jackson 5 arrive at Hitsville (July 1968)

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *The Motortown Revue: Dancing in the Street*

It's the team name plus a subtitle, like *Avengers: Age of Ultron*. Martha & the Vandellas' "Dancing in the Street" (1964) became tied to the unrest of the late 1960s, and some radio stations stopped playing it. To the public, it's a sequel to a period ensemble film (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Firsthand accounts: Martha Reeves, <i>Dancing in the Street</i> (1994); Mary Wilson, <i>Dreamgirl</i> (1986); Otis Williams, <i>Temptations</i> (1988)	1967 inside Motown, Florence, the riot and Ruffin
Mark Kurlansky, <i>Ready for a Brand New Beat</i> (2013)	The song, the riot and 1967 Detroit
The master recordings, the chart record, and the historical record of the July 1967 Detroit riot	Every song and date, and the riot shown accurately and respectfully

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: In 1967 the Motown family is at the height of its power when the machine that made them starts to crack and their city burns around them. By the end of 1968, half the team is gone and a new one is walking in the door.

Act One: The Peak (early 1967). The whole roster is at its height. The Supremes become "Diana Ross & the Supremes." Ruffin sings lead for the Temptations, Marvin and Tammi are Motown's dream duo, and Gladys Knight & the Pips push for their own place in line.

Act Two: The Fire (mid-1967). Florence Ballard is dismissed from the Supremes. On July 23, 1967, a police raid on 12th Street sets off five days of rioting. Motown's artists are on stage and in the streets as it happens, including Martha Reeves at the Fox Theatre. In October, Tammi collapses into Marvin's arms on stage. HDH stop delivering hits.

Act Three: The New Team (1968). Ruffin demands top billing and is fired (June 1968). Dennis Edwards and Cindy Birdsong step in. In the last scene, five brothers from Gary, Indiana walk into Hitsville for their audition (July 1968). The Revue goes on with a new lineup.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

The team's: the Motortown Revue. The Phase 1 and Phase 2 leads who were at Motown in 1967 are all here: Gordy, Ruffin (in his first team-up), Marvin, Smokey and Diana Ross. Everyone is at full strength (No-Nerf).

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The Motown machine's own pressure	Billing fights, dismissals and the royalty disputes behind HDH's slowdown. The system built to make stars now turns on them, like Ultron. No single villain: Gordy, Florence, Ruffin and HDH each appear as documented.
Tragedy	The Detroit riot (July 1967)	Shown through the eyes of real people. It's never staged as spectacle, and the 43 lives lost are honored.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	Early 1967 to July 1968. The fixed points are Florence's dismissal (July 1967), the riot (July 23–27, 1967), Tammi's collapse (Oct. 14, 1967), Ruffin's firing (June 1968), and the Jackson 5 audition (July 1968).
Where	Detroit (Hitsville, the Fox Theatre and 12th Street), Las Vegas (the Supremes' engagement), Hampden-Sydney College, Virginia, and the touring circuit.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Ten. It sits between the Revue of 1962 and <i>Hitsville 3</i> (1968 onward), and shares scenes with the Ruffin, Marvin, Smokey and Jackson 5 films.

7. Standalone World-Building

Detroit in 1967: the neighborhoods around Hitsville, the Fox Theatre, the city before and after the riot, and the Motown roster at its peak as an ensemble. A newcomer can follow it as a complete historical drama (60% serialized / 40% standalone, per Phase 2).

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in <i>Dancing in the Street</i>
Shared scenes	Ruffin's firing (<i>(I Know) I'm Losing You</i>), Tammi's collapse (<i>What's Going On</i>), HDH's exit (<i>Hitsville 3</i> , <i>The Tears of a Clown</i>), and the Jackson 5 audition (<i>I Want You Back</i>). All of them match exactly.
New faces	Gladys Knight & the Pips, Dennis Edwards and Cindy Birdsong, played by the actors introduced in <i>The Tears of a Clown</i> 's mid-credits where applicable.
Plot elements	Money and control grows from a ledger (Memo #015) into open lawsuits.

9. Post-Credits Scene: One (mid-credits)

Scene	What happens
Mid-credits (Detroit, 1968)	Lawyers file the suits, and then the countersuits, between Motown and Holland–Dozier–Holland. The ledger from the first Revue film sits open on the table. The saga's long-running threat is now out in the open. It mirrors <i>Age of Ultron</i> 's only extra scene, Thanos taking up the gauntlet.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 5 of 6. Released April 29, 2016.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 180 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. All shared scenes match their source films, Ruffin appears only on dates he was really at Motown, and the same actors return.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a period ensemble film about Motown in 1967, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.